

The Return

Near the end of the week. Plan on forty-five minutes. Don't rush it. The whole point is to give the page the time the practice asks you to give in real life. Keep it. You'll bring a piece of it to your Integration and Next-Step Session.

This journal rides one wave to shore, on the page, and then does the move the whole week is really about: coming back to the part of you that needed someone.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Five minutes of breath. Five in, seven out. When you've arrived, open your eyes and begin.

1. THE MOMENT

The same moment as The Protector, or a fresh one from this week that still has charge.
Two or three sentences.

2. THE BODY NOW

Close your eyes, let the moment come back, and drop into the body. Where is something present right now, and what's its quality?

3. RIDE THE WAVE

Set a timer for three minutes. Close your eyes. Bring your attention to where the sensation is. Don't try to change it. Don't analyze it. Don't make it bigger or smaller. Keep it company. If your mind drifts into the story, come back to the sensation. If it's too much, rest in the breath or your hands, then return.

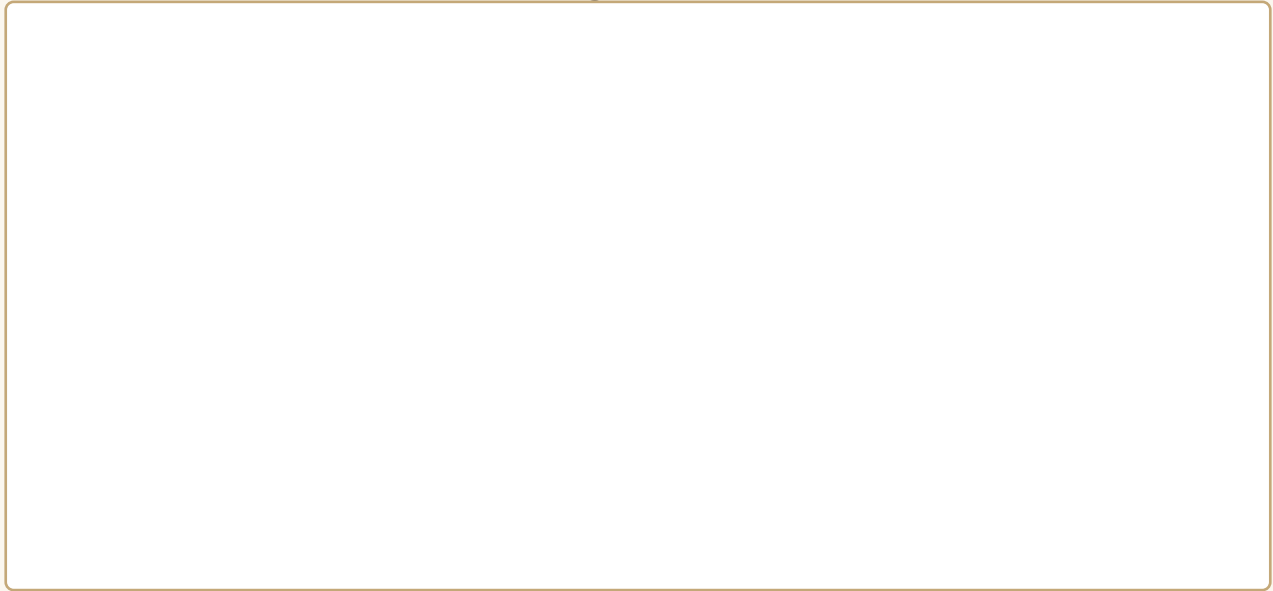
When the timer goes off, write what happened. Did it move? Soften? Get sharper before it eased? Change location, throat to chest to belly? Did anything shift in your breath or your shoulders? If nothing seemed to happen, write that. Sometimes the wave moves below what you can notice in three minutes. That's information too.



4. WHAT SURFACED

Often, when you ride a wave to its end, something arrives that you couldn't have thought your way to. A memory. A sentence. A clear sense of what you actually want. A younger version of you, at a specific age.

What surfaced? Don't force it. If nothing is clear, write what's there.



5. THE RETURN

This is the move the practice is really about.

If there's a tender place, or a younger version of you, or an ache, or even just the protector still holding tight, turn toward it on the page. Address it directly. Write what you'd say to it if you knew the right thing to say.

It doesn't have to be eloquent. The sentences that land are the ones a good parent would say to a frightened kid. I see you. I know this hurts. I'm not going anywhere. I'm here. You don't have to do this alone.

You're being the one who comes back. Write whatever wants to come.



6. WHAT SHIFTED

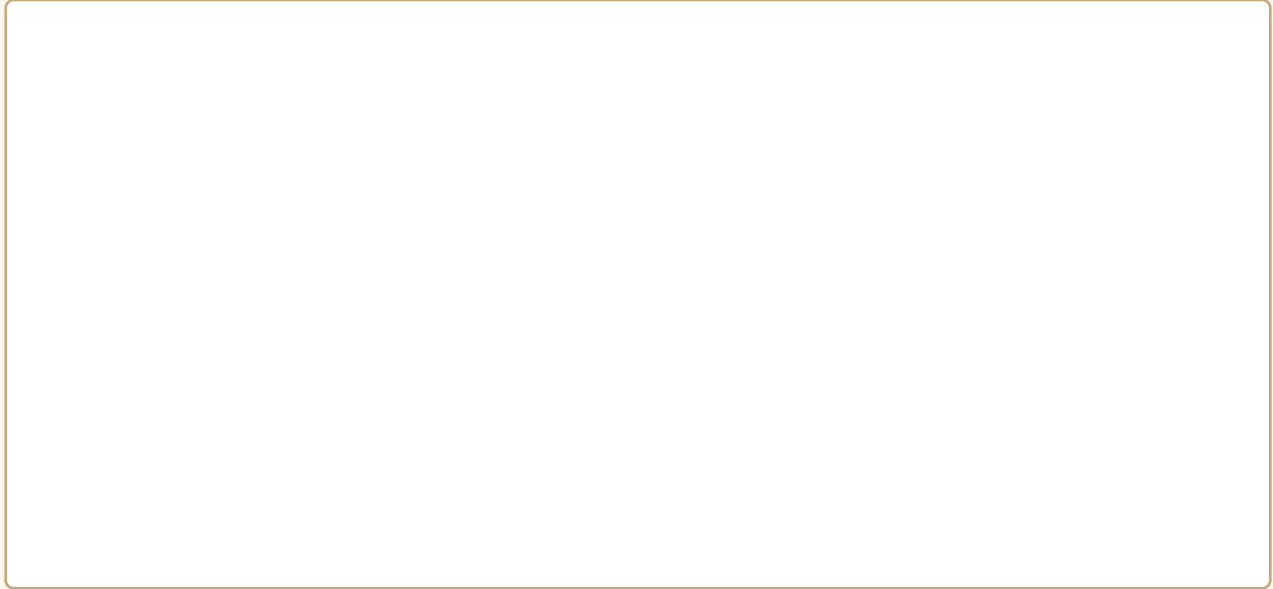
Look back over this journal, and over the week. What's changed in your body since the start? Even a small shift counts. Looser breath, dropped shoulders, less of a knot, a quiet you didn't have before.

7. A NEW MOVE

One move you're carrying into next week. Concrete. The thirty-second stay in a specific situation that always fires. A question dropped into the body. A part you're going to stop fighting, for now. Just one.

CLOSING THE WEEK

What's one thing you're taking with you from this week?



What's an open question you're left with?

